

This is a fairly sensible approach, as on hover, the link colour will change to satisfactorily identify the link, so underlines are not needed. It is generally recommended that all other link states carry an underline to distinguish them from normal inactive text, and it is not a good idea to identify links with colour alone.

7.5.2 Using borders with links

The border property turns off the default underlines and replaces them with custom bottom borders and can be used to create some good effects. In the example, all basic links will be given a thin dotted underline, which is actually a 1-pixel bottom border:

```
a:link {  
color:#F00;  
text-decoration:none;  
border-bottom:1px dashed #333;  
line-height:150%;  
}
```

Note that unlike the text-decoration property, here the border can be a different colour from the link text, so you can have red text with dark gray underlines. Also, with a line-height declared, you ensure that the underline doesn't encroach upon any text underneath it.

7.5.3 Adding symbols with background images

It should also be obvious that a background image can also be applied to links. Here a different background image can be applied to each of the four link states, further aiding usability by providing a visual indicator alongside the more traditional text variations. For this example, the goal is to use an arrow symbol to indicate links not yet visited and a checkmark to indicate links already visited. For this you will need two small GIF images sized approximately 12×12 pixels.

As each image is 12 pixels in width, it makes sense to provide enough padding to the right of the link text for the image to be placed. Here, 15 pixels are declared for the right padding. Also, the arrow image is assigned to the background property for the :link pseudo class, set to only appear once, at right center. The checkmark image is assigned in an identical way for the :visited pseudo link.

```
a:link {  
color:#F00;  
padding:0 15px 0 0;  
background:url(images/arrow.gif) no-repeat right center;
```